

Frank Lloyd Wright

Structures designed in harmony with modern life and the environment were the hallmark of US architect Frank Lloyd Wright (1867–1959), who also designed his own furniture, fittings and stained glass. After studying engineering, Wright worked with Joseph Lyman Silsbee (1848–1913) and was apprenticed to Louis Sullivan. On leaving Sullivan in 1893, he designed the Winslow House in Illinois, with a strong horizontal emphasis and expansive interior spaces. Winslow House heralded a succession of Wright designs that, in their harmony with the environment and use of local natural elements, were later dubbed ‘organic architecture’. His original approach and ideas emerged in offices, churches, schools, skyscrapers, hotels and museums; but designs like Winslow House, which exaggerated horizontals and low, pitched roofs, became known as the Prairie School of architecture. Many of his works defy categorization, such as the ochre concrete Fallingwater (1935, opposite), cantilevered above a Pennsylvania waterfall, and the white concrete spiral of the Guggenheim Museum (1959) in New York.

